

# The UPSC Syllabus, on One Page

The entire Civil Services Examination — Prelims, Mains, and Interview — laid out visually so you always know where you stand.

| STAGE 1 – PRELIMS (SCREENING)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  | STAGE 2 – MAINS (WRITTEN)                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | STAGE 3 – INTERVIEW (PERSONALITY TEST) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Prelims                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  | Mains — 9 Papers Total                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                        |
| <div><b>GS Paper I</b>200 marks</div> <div>Current events · History of India &amp; National Movement · Indian &amp; World Geography · Polity &amp; Governance · Economic &amp; Social Development · Environmental Ecology, Biodiversity &amp; Climate Change · General Science</div> |  | <div><b>Paper A &amp; B — Language</b>2 × 300, qualifying</div> <div>One Indian language (from the 8th Schedule) + English. Matriculation-level. 25% needed to qualify — marks not counted in merit, but failing disqualifies you outright.</div> |                                        |
| <div><b>CSAT (GS Paper II)</b>200 marks · qualifying</div> <div>Comprehension · Interpersonal &amp; communication skills · Logical reasoning &amp; analytical ability · Decision-making &amp; problem-solving · General mental ability · Basic numeracy (Class X level)</div>        |  | <div><b>Essay</b>250 marks</div> <div>Two essays, chosen from a list of topics. Tests structure, originality and clarity of thought as much as content.</div>                                                                                     |                                        |
| Only GS Paper I marks count toward the Mains cutoff. CSAT just needs 33% to qualify — but don't neglect it.                                                                                                                                                                          |  | <div><b>GS I — Heritage, History &amp; Geography</b>250 marks</div> <div>Indian Heritage &amp; Culture · History of India &amp; the World · Society · World &amp; Indian Geography</div>                                                          |                                        |
| Interview                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  | <div><b>GS II — Governance &amp; Polity</b>250 marks</div> <div>Constitution · Polity · Social Justice · Governance · International Relations</div>                                                                                               |                                        |
| <div><b>Personality Test</b>275 marks</div> <div>A conversation based on your DAF (Detailed Application Form) — your background, hobbies, optional subject, work experience, and current affairs. Tests judgement and composure, not just knowledge.</div>                           |  | <div><b>GS III — Economy, Tech &amp; Security</b>250 marks</div> <div>Technology · Economic Development · Biodiversity &amp; Environment · Security · Disaster Management</div>                                                                   |                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  | <div><b>GS IV — Ethics</b>250 marks</div> <div>Ethics, Integrity &amp; Aptitude — including case studies</div>                                                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  | <div><b>Optional Subject — Paper I &amp; II</b>2 × 250 = 500 marks</div> <div>One subject you choose (Geography, Polity/PSIR and Psychology are especially well covered in our Mains Mastery Program)</div>                                       |                                        |
| 1750<br>MAINS MARKS TOWARD MERIT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  | 275<br>INTERVIEW MARKS                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2025<br>TOTAL FINAL MERIT MARKS        |